Clocks and Elapsed Time

TEACHER KEY

3rd Grade Math · Interactive Math · Explore & Reflect

Get started

Set a start clock and an end clock to the nearest minute. A number-line timeline shows the jump to the next hour, whole hours and minutes, and the total elapsed time. Open the tool and use it to answer each question.

Explore

1. A clock shows the hour hand just past 7 and the minute hand 3 marks past the 4. What time is it?

7:23

2. How much time passes from 3:10 to 3:55?

45 minutes

3. How much time passes from 8:40 to 9:15?

35 minutes (20 minutes to 9:00, then 15 more)

4. Recess starts at 1:25 and lasts 50 minutes. When does it end?

2:15

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Explore more

5. How long is it from 11:30 to 1:05?

1 hour 35 minutes

6. A movie ended at 4:00. It lasted 1 hour 20 minutes. When did it start?

2:40

Reflect

7. Reflect: Why is it helpful to jump to the next hour first?

Whole hours are easy to count; the leftover minutes are added at the start and end.

Teacher notes

- Have students sketch the timeline in their notebooks while the tool shows it.
- Use school events (lunch 11:45 to 12:20) for real elapsed-time problems.
- For start-time problems, set the end clock first and move the start clock back.

Standards: 3.MD.A.1. Accept any correct answer where several are possible, and ask students to explain with the tool's picture.